Naik Bahadur Singh of 6 Kumaon (413962) was awarded the Vir Chakra posthumously at McMahon Ridge, Kibithu area, on 21 October 1962
Rifleman Purna Bahadur Tamang of 2 Assam Rifles (29659) was awarded the Vir Chakra in the Kibithu area on 22 October 1962
Sepoy Kewal Singh of 4 Sikh (3349770) was awarded the Maha Vir Chakra posthumously at Mithun, Walong area, on 26-27 October 1962
Second Lieutenant Pradeep Singh Bhandari (IC-123221) of 71 Heavy Mortar Battery was awarded the Vir Chakra at Green Pimple on 3 November 1962
Subedar Jagandhoy Limbu of 2 Assam Rifles (26460) was awarded the Vir Chakra at Walong on 4 November 1962
Captain Ravi Kumar Mathur of 6 Kumaon (IC-10156) was awarded the Vir Chakra at Walong on 6 November 1962
Captain Balbir Chand Chopra from the AMC (MS6455) was awarded the Vir Chakra at Walong on 14 November 1962
2/Lt Amar Singh Khatri of 6 Kumaon (IC-12970) was awarded the Vir Chakra at Yellow Pimple on 14 November 1962
Captain Prem Nath Bhatia of 6 Kumaon (IC-7077) was awarded the Vir Chakra at Walong on 15 November 1962
Lieutenant Yog Raj Palta of 4 Sikh (IC-11832) was awarded the Vir Chakra posthumously at Walong on 15 November 1962
Havildar Kirpa Ram of 4 Sikh (3330962) was awarded the Vir Chakra posthumously at Walong on 15 November 1962

CHAPTER 10: FORTRESS SE-LA

248 At the time, unaccountably: Major General D. K. Palit, *War in the High Himalaya*, p 50

256 The Chinese knew everything: Tashi Sonam in a conversation with the author in 2009 in Tawang

In 2008 the author met Tashi Sonam, a former Intelligence operative in Tawang. The Intelligence officer accompanying me said: ‘He was present in Tawang when the Chinese came here in 1962. He was one of the key people working for the Intelligence Bureau at that time and continued to work for them till he retired.’

Over cups of tea, the old man enthralled us with his stories. I suppose the years he had to spend in silence as a spy, keeping his identity a secret, was having the opposite effect on him now. He spoke lucidly of the many trips he had made to Lhasa as an agent, and the various routes and passes that linked Tibet across the watershed to India. He then mentioned 1942 in passing, referring to it as the first Tibetan invasion. Even though he said it more than once, I presumed the old man had got his dates mixed up by a couple of decades, and did not contradict him. A year later, I was working on the Assam Rifles book. A lot that Tashi Sonam had said in passing now began to make sense. Fortunately, I was again invited by the brigade in Tawang to photograph the flag meeting with the Chinese at Bum-la. Needless to say, I didn’t